

WEEK 4 | GUI & Problem-Solving Agent

Lab Objective

The objective of this lab is to:

- Build a simple **Graphical User Interface (GUI)** using **Streamlit**.
- Understand how a **Problem-Solving Agent** works in practice
- Implement the agent's reasoning steps in a **structured computational pipeline**

Tools & Technologies

- Python 3.x
- Streamlit
- Standard Python libraries (lists, dictionaries, functions)

Part A: GUI Development Using Streamlit

Purpose

Streamlit allows rapid development of interactive web applications using pure Python.

Official Documentation: <https://docs.streamlit.io/>

Basic Streamlit Workflow

A Streamlit application follows a **top-to-bottom execution model**:

1. Define page title and description
2. Accept user inputs through widgets
3. Process inputs using backend logic
4. Display outputs dynamically

Commonly Used Streamlit Components

Component	Usage
st.title()	Display application title
st.text_input()	Accept textual input
st.number_input()	Accept numeric input
st.selectbox()	Select one option from multiple

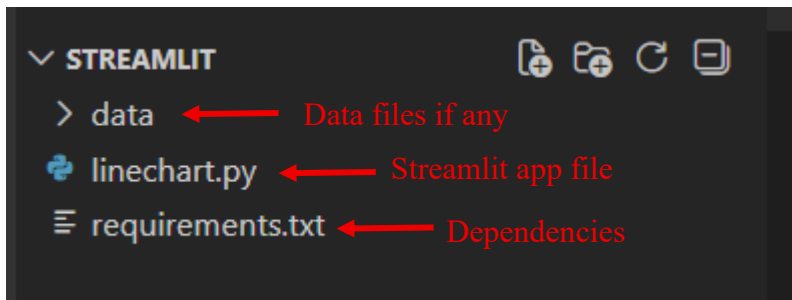
st.button()	Trigger computation
st.write()	Display text or results
st.success()	Display success messages

Setup Instructions

1. Create Your Python File

- Open **VS Code** (not Jupyter Notebook)
- Create a new file with .py extension
- **Correct:** app.py, interface.py, dashboard.py
- **Incorrect:** .ipynb, .txt, or any other format

2. File Structure



3. Basic Streamlit Template

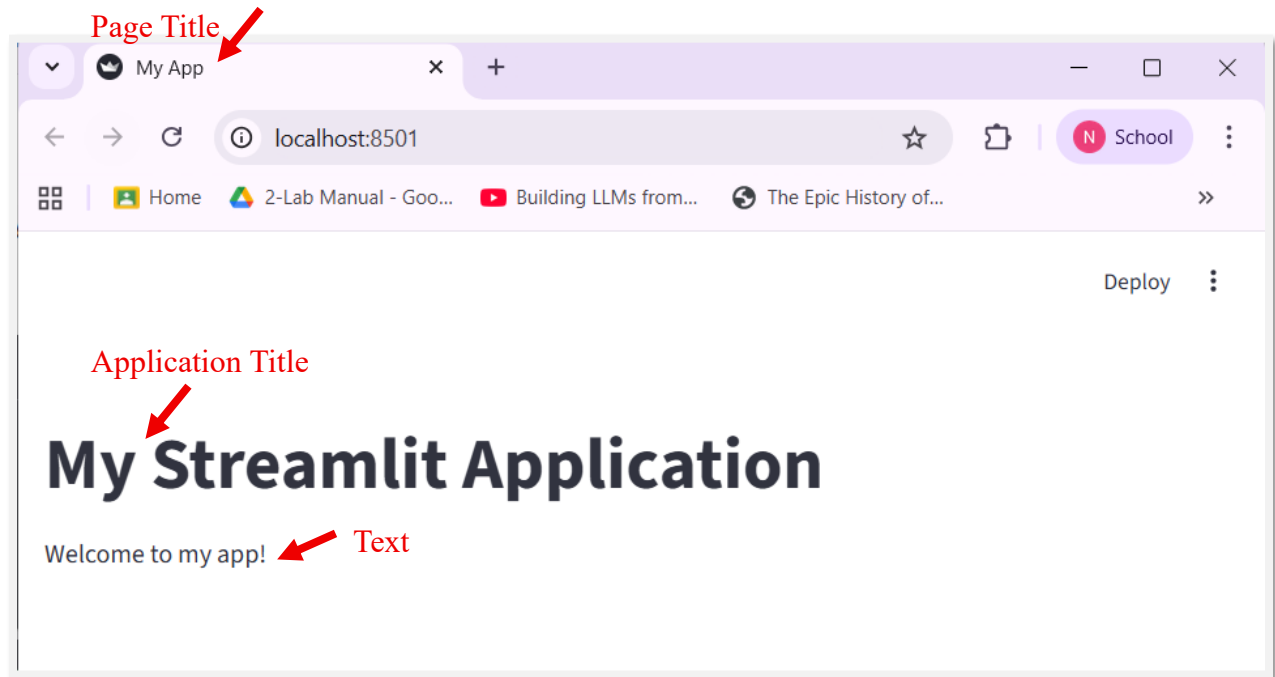
Start with this minimal template in your .py file:

```
import streamlit as st
import pandas as pd
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt

# Set page configuration (first command)
st.set_page_config(page_title="My App", layout="wide")

# application code
st.title("My Streamlit Application")
st.write("Welcome to my app!")
```

Command to Run Streamlit web App: `streamlit run fileName.py`



Example#1 Interface:

```
import streamlit as st
import numpy as np
import pandas as pd

# Line Chart

chart_data = pd.DataFrame(
    np.random.randn(20, 3),
    columns=['a', 'b', 'c'])

st.line_chart(chart_data)

# Dataframe Display

st.write("Here's our first attempt at using data to create a table:")
st.write(pd.DataFrame({
    'first column': [1, 2, 3, 4],
    'second column': [10, 20, 30, 40]
}))
```



Download as CSV

Here's our first attempt at using data to create a table:

	first column	second column	
0		1	10
1		2	20
2		3	30
3		4	40

Default Options for DataFrame

Example#2 Interface:

```
import streamlit as st

st.title("AI Input-Output Demo")

number = st.number_input("Enter a number", value=0)

if st.button("Calculate Square"):
    st.success(f"Model Output: {number ** 2}")
```

AI Input-Output Demo

Enter a number

2

- +

Calculate Square

Model Output: 4

Example#3: Markdown

Basic Syntax

```
st.markdown("<p>Hello</p>", unsafe_allow_html=True)
```

You can add **styling**

Change Font Size

```
st.markdown(
    "<p style='font-size:24px;'>Hello World</p>",
    unsafe_allow_html=True
)
```

Change Font Color

```
st.markdown(
    "<p style='color:red;'>Hello World</p>",
    unsafe_allow_html=True
)
```

Change BOTH Size and Color

```
st.markdown(
    "<p style='font-size:28px; color:blue;'>Styled Text</p>",
    unsafe_allow_html=True
)
```

Two buttons, CSS applied to only one

A simple reliable approach is to use HTML buttons with unique IDs:

```
import streamlit as st
```

```
st.markdown("""
```

```
<style>
```

```
#red-button {
```

```
    background-color: red;
```

```
    color: white;
```

```
padding: 10px 20px;
border-radius: 8px;
}
</style>

"", unsafe_allow_html=True)

st.markdown('<button id="red-button">Delete</button>', unsafe_allow_html=True)

st.button("Save")
```

Here:

- **Delete** → custom CSS applied
- **Save** → normal Streamlit button

The important concept is that CSS needs a **selector** to identify *which element* to style. An id is one way to uniquely identify a specific HTML element.

Key Points

1. **Streamlit reruns the entire script on every interaction**
Typing, clicking, or changing input → full rerun (by design).
2. **Heavy logic should never run by default**
Loops, ML models, and long computations must be **inside if st.button()** or similar conditions.
3. **Use caching for expensive work**
`@st.cache_data` or `@st.cache_resource` prevents recomputation on every rerun.

Example:

```
@st.cache_data

def load_data():

    df = pd.read_csv("students.csv")

    return df

data = load_data()
```

```
@st.cache_resource

def load_model():

    model = joblib.load("model.pkl")

    return model

prediction = model.predict([[25, 50000]])
```

- **@st.cache_data** is for caching **data/results**, such as DataFrames, API responses, or calculation results. Streamlit manages these as cached data and returns copies.
- **@st.cache_resource** is for caching **long-lived resources/objects**, such as ML models, database connections, or large model pipelines. Streamlit keeps and reuses the same object.

4. Rerun is cheap, computation is not

UI reruns are fast; only uncontrolled loops make apps slow.

Concept	Purpose	Example Use Case
Heavy logic should never run by default	Control when code runs	Button-gated ML inference, loops, or dataset processing
Caching expensive work	Control how many times code runs	Large dataset preprocessing, ML model predictions, repeated computations

For more examples, Explore Official Documentation: <https://docs.streamlit.io/>

Part B: Problem Solving Agent Architecture

State Representation

A state represents the complete information required by an intelligent agent to describe its current situation at a specific point in time.

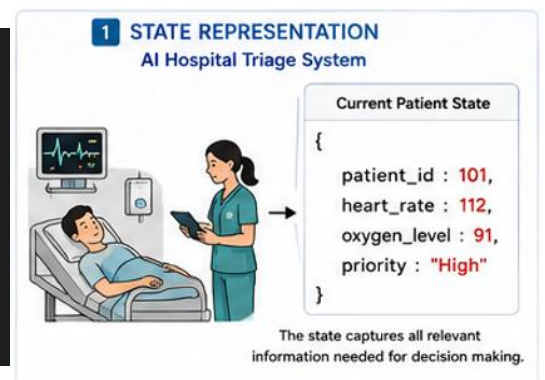
- States may be represented using dictionaries, tuples, strings, or custom objects.
- The representation should capture all relevant information needed for decision making.
- Well-designed state representations simplify reasoning and state transitions.

Use Case: AI Hospital Triage System

Represent the current condition of a patient before making any medical decision.

```
# Current patient state
patient_state = {
    "patient_id": 101,
    "heart_rate": 112,
    "oxygen_level": 91,
    "priority": "High"
}

print(patient_state)
```



Tip:

- Store all relevant attributes within the state.

- Choose immutable structures (e.g., tuples) when states need to be stored inside sets or dictionaries

Representing Graphs or Adjacency Lists

Many AI applications represent environments as graphs where each node represents a **state** and edges represent possible **transitions**.

- **Dictionaries** provide an efficient way to represent graph structures.
- Edge weights can represent distance, travel time, or cost.

Use Case: AI Navigation System (Google Maps)

```
road_network = {

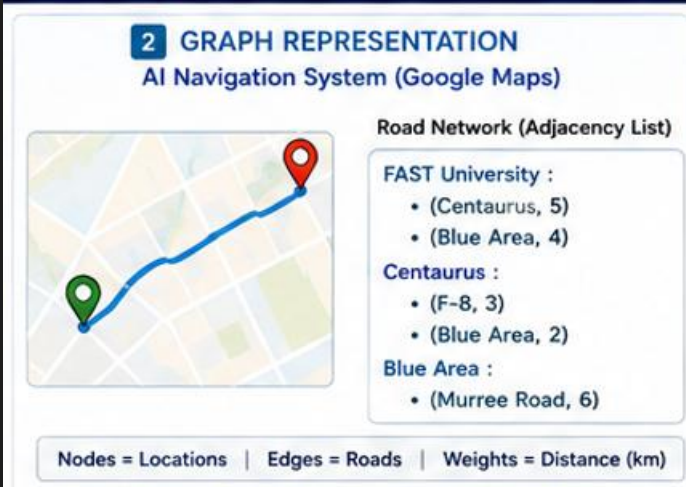
    "FAST University": [
        ("Centaurus", 5),
        ("Blue Area", 4)
    ],

    "Centaurus": [
        ("F-8", 3),
        ("Blue Area", 2)
    ],

    "Blue Area": [
        ("Murree Road", 6)
    ]

}

for neighbor, distance in road_network["FAST University"]:
    print(neighbor, distance)
```



Tip: Store neighboring locations together with edge costs to support future search algorithms.

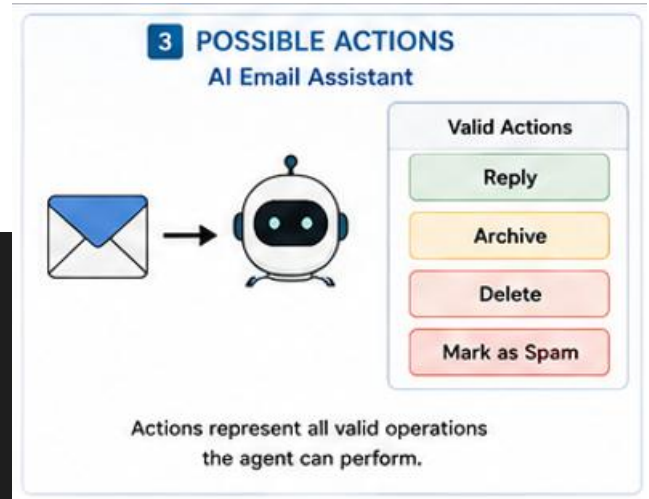
Possible Actions

Actions describe all valid operations that can transform one state into another.

- Every action modifies the current state.
- Invalid actions should not be executed.

Use Case: AI Email Assistant

```
actions = [
    "Reply",
    "Archive",
    "Delete",
    "Mark as Spam"
]
print(actions)
```



Tip: Clearly define all valid actions before designing the agent's decision-making logic.

Transition Model (Applying Actions)

The Transition Model defines how an action changes the current state into a new state.

Use Case: Food Delivery Tracking System

```
def dispatch_order(order):

    order["status"] = "Out for Delivery"

    return order

order = {

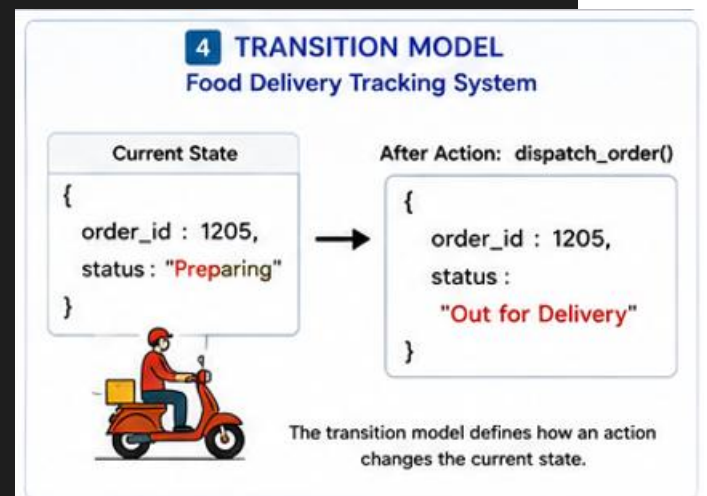
    "order_id": 1205,

    "status": "Preparing"

}

updated_order = dispatch_order(order)

print(updated_order)
```



Tip: Always validate whether an action is applicable before updating the current state.

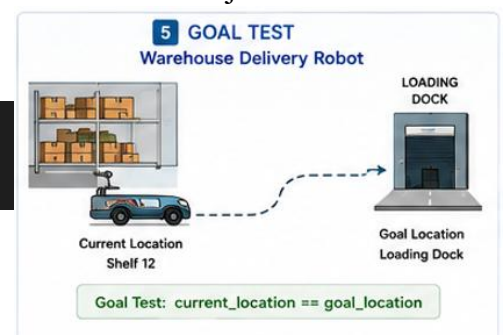
Goal Test

A Goal Test determines whether the agent has successfully achieved the desired objective.

Use Case: Warehouse Delivery Robot

```
def goal_test(current_location, goal_location):

    return current_location == goal_location
```



```
current_location = "Loading Dock"

goal_location = "Loading Dock"

print(goal_test(current_location, goal_location))
```

Tip: Keep goal tests simple and efficient because they may be evaluated repeatedly during problem solving.

Path Cost Calculation

Path cost represents the cumulative cost incurred while moving from the initial state to the goal state.

Use Case: Ride-Hailing Service

```
trip_cost = {

    "fuel": 350,

    "toll": 150,

    "parking": 100

}

total_cost = sum(trip_cost.values())

print("Total Cost:", total_cost)
```



Tip: The cost function may represent distance, travel time, fuel consumption, monetary expense, or any other optimization criterion.

Cycle Avoidance / Visited States

Many AI problems contain repeated states. Revisiting previously explored states increases computation and may create infinite loops.

Use Case: Robot Vacuum Cleaner

```
visited_rooms = set()

rooms = [
```

```

    "Kitchen",

    "Bedroom",

    "Kitchen",

    "Living Room"
]

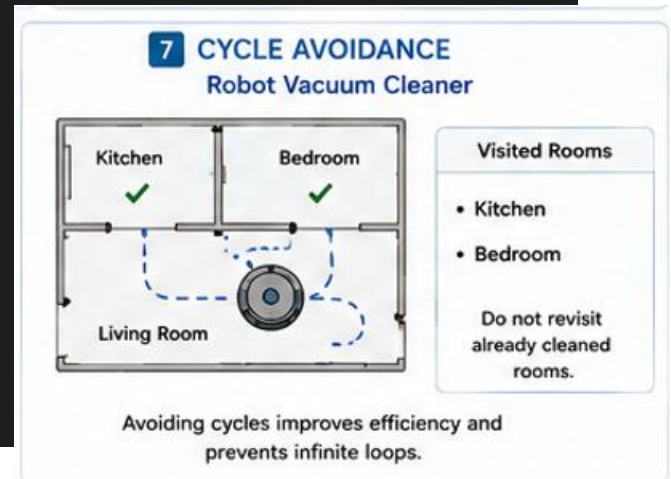
for room in rooms:

    if room not in visited_rooms:

        print("Cleaning:", room)

        visited_rooms.add(room)

```



Tip: Sets provide fast membership testing and are commonly used to store visited states.

State-Space Generation (Enumeration)

State-space generation explores all possible future states reachable from the current state.

Use Case: Delivery Robot

```

locations = {

    "Warehouse": ["Street A", "Street B"],

    "Street A": ["Customer 1"],

    "Street B": ["Customer 2"]

}

stack = ["Warehouse"]

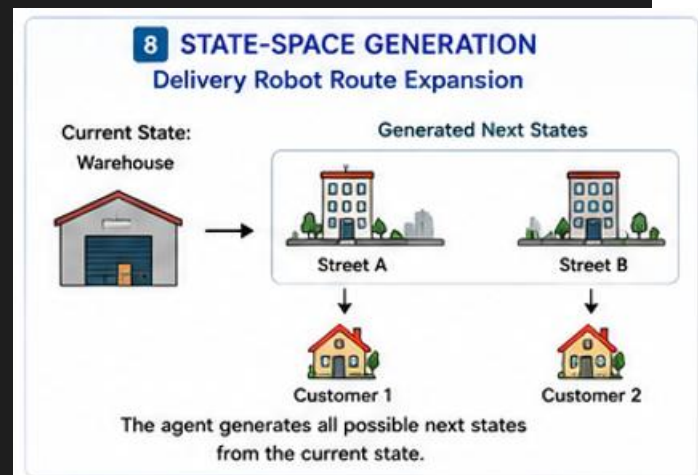
while stack:

    current = stack.pop()

    print(current)

    if current in locations:

```



```
stack.extend(locations[current])
```

Tip: Generate the state space gradually to verify correctness before implementing search algorithms (Use **stack** or **queue** for explicit exploration (without BFS/DFS)).

A **Problem-Solving Agent** solves a problem by following a fixed sequence of reasoning steps. Each step converts raw input into a structured decision.

Goal Formulation

Goal Formulation determines what the agent intends to achieve based on the current situation and the performance measure.

Use Case: Smart Home Climate Control

```
def formulate_goal(current_temperature):  
    if current_temperature > 28:  
        return "Cool Room"  
    elif current_temperature < 20:  
        return "Heat Room"  
    else:  
        return "Maintain Temperature"  
  
goal = formulate_goal(31)  
print(goal)
```



Tip: A well-defined goal guides all subsequent decision-making performed by the agent.

Problem Formulation

Problem Formulation converts the selected goal into a structured computational problem by defining the initial state, goal state, actions, and constraints.

Use Case: Hospital Appointment Scheduling

```
problem = {  
  
    "initial_state": "Appointment Not Scheduled",  
  
    "goal_state": "Appointment Confirmed",  
  
    "actions": [  
  
        "Search Doctor",  
  
        "Select Time Slot",  
  
        "Confirm Appointment"  
  
    ],  
  
    "constraints": "Doctor must be available"  
  
}  
  
print(problem)
```



Tip: Clearly defining the problem reduces ambiguity during the search process.

Searching for a Solution

Searching systematically explores available actions until a sequence leading to the goal state is discovered.

Use Case: Hotel Booking Assistant

```
hotels = [  
  
    {"name": "Hotel A", "available": False},  
  
    {"name": "Hotel B", "available": False},  
  
    {"name": "Hotel C", "available": True}  
  
]  
  
for hotel in hotels:
```



```

if hotel["available"]:

    print("Selected:", hotel["name"])

    break

```

Tip: Searching is the process of evaluating possible alternatives until a satisfactory solution is identified.

Executing the Solution

After identifying a valid solution, the agent executes each action sequentially until the desired goal is achieved.

Use Case: Food Delivery Workflow

```

delivery_steps = [

    "Accept Order",

    "Assign Rider",

    "Pick Up Food",

    "Deliver Order"

]

for step in delivery_steps:

    print(step)

print("Delivery Completed Successfully")

```



Tip: Execution applies the selected plan in the real environment and produces the final outcome.

Complete Agent Flow (Conceptual)

User Input/Request (Raw) → Goal Formulation

- Problem Formulation
- Search for Solution
- Solution/pipeline Execution

→ Final Output

Use Case: AI Hospital Appointment Assistant

